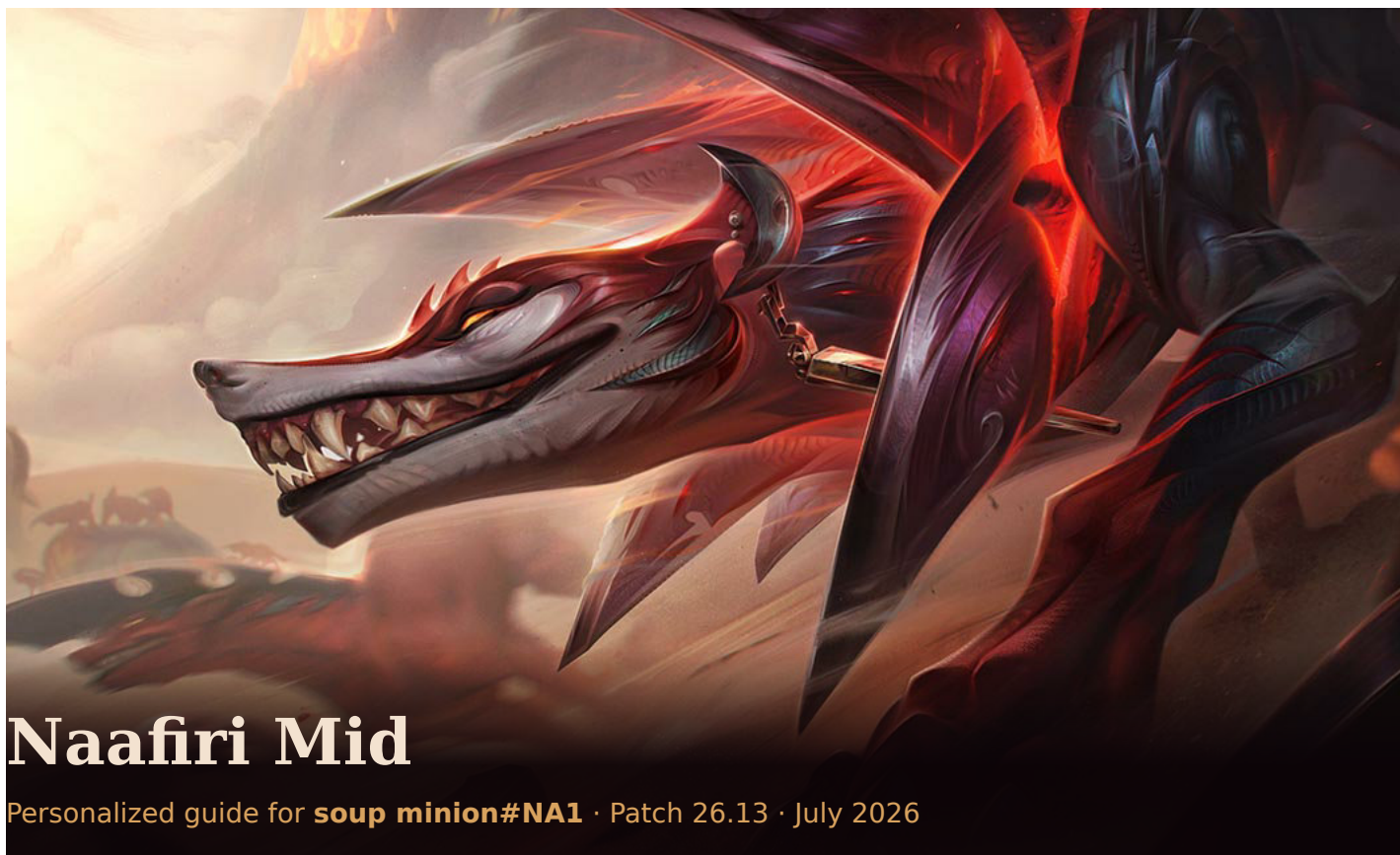




Naafiri Mid

Personalized guide for **soup minion#NA1** · Patch 26.13 · July 2026

Labels: **VERIFIED** multi-source fact-checked · **SINGLE SOURCE** · **REASONING** from current-patch numbers, verify in practice tool · **YOUR DATA** from your 59 Naafiri games this season.

The Diagnosis

YOUR DATA Mid Naafiri is your best champion: 62% WR this season, 9.5 kills/game. The two leaks keeping the account at Gold 3 are **kill participation (~43%; 8 of 28 ranked losses at ≤32%)** and losses ending at **~27 min — faster than your wins**. You lose games in the mid game while farming away from the map, not late. One skill fixes it: **converting lane advantage into map presence, minutes 8-25 (\$6-7)**.

1 · Kit & Mechanics



Passive — We Are More

Packmates attack your targets. Damage multiplier, DoT-keystone applicator, and skillshot shields vs mages.



Q — Darkin Daggers (9-7s CD, starts after 2nd cast)

Q1 bleeds; Q2 detonates remaining bleed + missing-health bonus, and heals you vs champions. Treat the two casts as one input — Q1 hit means Q2 always follows. Throw Q1 when their movement is committed (stepping up to last-hit, mid-cast animation) or after you've conditioned a dodge direction — never at neutral. A missed Q1 is your whole offense on cooldown: play it like Zed after both Qs whiff — back off until it's up again.



W — The Call of the Pack (22-18s CD)

On cast: **1s untargetability** (your only one — see R), then a 5s hunt: **+20% bonus AD**, faster packmates, and **2 extra packmates arriving 1.25s after cast**. You can move during the 0.75s cast, and each R cast extends the hunt 1.75s. All-in steroid *and* defensive cooldown in one button — the timing rules are in §1b. **VERIFIED**



E — Eviscerate (11-7s CD, 450 dash)

Dash + two-hit AoE, no cast time; **gains bonus range through terrain — a real wall-hop** **VERIFIED**. Packmates vanish during the dash and reappear healed to full. Your gap-closer and only escape. Count their answers before spending it: E-ing in while their charm/hook/exhaust is up is diving without a dash home — the mistake every Akali makes once per game. In poke lanes, hold E to sidestep the return skillshot after your Q; a held E also changes how they play, the same way an unused Fizz E does.



R — Hounds' Pursuit (110/95/80s CD, 900 range, point-and-click dash)

VERIFIED Champion takedown within 7s of cast → reveal pulse + **one free recast within 12s**, and the recast grants a 3s shield (100/150/200 + 150% bonus AD). Stack with Axiom Arc's takedown ult-refund: R → kill → shielded free R → kill → half the CD already back. Play it like Katarina plays resets: the first kill isn't the end of the play, and you should know target #2 *before* you press R the first time.

Two facts most Naafiris get wrong **VERIFIED**: during the dash **only the packmates are untargetable — you are not** (W is your untargetability, not R); and the 0.75s channel **disables your other casts** — but inputs pressed during the dash are queued and fire the instant you land (§1b tech).

1b • Combos — The Full Move List

Sources: Mobalytics S26 combo page + League wiki mechanics; each combo cross-checked against current cast times and buffer rules. Q1/Q2 = the two Darkin Daggers casts, AA = auto.

Combo	Input	When & why the order matters
Bleed trade (poke) VERIFIED	Q1 → wait 1–2 ticks → Q2	Your bread-and-butter poke. Q2's detonation scales up to +250% with missing HP, so letting the bleed tick first makes the same Q hit harder and heal more. Opposite rule on waves: detonate instantly so the cooldown starts.
Extended trade VERIFIED	Q1 → AA → E → Q2 → AA	When they step up. The AA fills Q's 0.5s recast lockout; E has no cast time so it lands mid-trade — aim it <i>at</i> them to stick or <i>away</i> to make it poke-and-out; Q2 last for the amp.
Pre-6 all-in VERIFIED	Q1 → W → E → AA-AA → Q2	Kill-threat trade without R. W while walking at them (you keep moving during its cast): the 1s untargetability eats their trade-back, +20% AD boosts the rest, and the 2 bonus packmates land right as you E in. HoB variant in §2b.
Post-6 all-in — the core combo VERIFIED	W → Q1 → R (queue Q2) → E → AA-AA	W first , always: its buffs live through the whole route, R extends the hunt 1.75s, and its untargetability absorbs their first answer during your R channel. Q1 before R so the bleed ticks during the dash; Q2 queued during the dash detonates on landing; E follows their sidestep.
Edge-of-range all-in SINGLE SOURCE	Q1 → R → Q2 → E	Simpler variant when they're at max range: Q1 and R both reach 900. Vs Zhonya's/stopwatch: run them down with E and bait it <i>before</i> committing R.
Flash burst SINGLE SOURCE	Q1 → W → Q2 → Flash → E → AA	Cheese kill on a low target hugging tower range. Q2 banks the detonation first; Flash→E is instant on arrival. Hard — practice-tool it first.
Fog pick SINGLE SOURCE	R → queued Q1 → AA → E → Q2 → AA	Roam opener from a bush/fog. Hold W here — it's your panic button against the peel that answers the dive, not part of the opener. Note the 0.75s channel reveals you to the target: expect one reaction.
Teamfight reset weave VERIFIED	R carry → any takedown ≤7s → recast (3s shield) → target #2	Any champion takedown arms the recast — not just your R target. Ult the backliner while your bled target dies to your team; the recast shields you <i>before</i> the second dash and can target through fog (the takedown reveals 4s). One W covers both dives. Details §8.
Escape VERIFIED	W → E through a wall	W's 1s untargetability drops the targeted spell or turret shot mid-flight; E's terrain bonus range makes thin walls jumpable. You lose no distance — W casts while you run. Post-takedown, a defensive R recast (shield + dash to a <i>safer</i> enemy) is the advanced exit.

Tech notes

- **The R buffer:** casting is disabled during the R dash, so *queue* the next input (Q or E) mid-dash — it fires the frame you land. This is the difference between "R, land, then start comboing" and landing with the bleed already ticking. **SINGLE SOURCE** (engine-verified mechanic; phrased as "queue," not a frame-perfect cancel).
- **W timing:** cast W ~1.5s before contact, while approaching. Earlier wastes the untargetability; later and the 2 bonus packmates (1.25s spawn delay) miss the start of the fight. This is exactly the §2b HoB route's pre-cast.
- **Q2 rule of thumb:** vs champions, delay Q2 for the missing-HP amp and the heal; vs waves, detonate instantly to start the cooldown sooner.

2 · Rune Pages & Builds — The Four Setups

Keystone data, Emerald+ mid 26.13, lolalytics n≈54k, re-verified twice **VERIFIED**: **Hail of Blades** most-picked **and** highest WR (53.7%, 25.2k games) · **Deathfire Touch** right behind (53.3%, 14.7k — your default is statistically sound, 0.4pp off the top) · **Electrocute** lags (51.8%, 11.9k) · **Conqueror** is a trap in lane (49.4%). At your elo the champion is even better: **Gold mid Naafiri is S-tier, rank 4 of 98 (52.67%, 78k games)**.

 **SETUP A — Hail of Blades**

DEFAULT TARGET — highest WR + most picked; needs the \$2b route

Primary — Domination	Secondary — Sorcery	Shards	Build order
Hail of Blades Sudden Impact Sixth Sense Treasure Hunter	Transcendence Scorch	Attack Speed Adaptive Health	Lethality core: Doran's →  Brutalizer (1st back) →  Voltaic →  Glutt. Greaves (→ Immortal Path) →  Axiom Arc →  Serylda's → situational (\$3)

VERIFIED 53.7% WR on 25.2k games — the best-performing page in the biggest sample. It only pays when you commit to the three autos (\$2b, \$1b pre-6 all-in); if you catch yourself pure-poking, you're playing Setup B with a dead keystone.

 **SETUP B — Deathfire Touch lethality**

YOUR DEFAULT — poke lanes, and every game you don't feel the all-in

Primary — Sorcery	Secondary — Precision	Shards	Build order
Deathfire Touch Manaflow Band Transcendence Scorch	Legend: Haste Cut Down	Adaptive Adaptive HP%	Doran's →  Brutalizer →  Voltaic →  Glutt. Greaves →  Axiom Arc →  Serylda's (Eclipse- first also fine on this page — see Setup D note)

VERIFIED This exact page is lolalytics' DFT cohort (53.3% WR, 14.4k games — every rune row confirmed live), and it's your page: your 38 games run it at 62%. The keystone is legitimate, not a comfort tax. Know its 26.11 nerf: the burn is **magic-only** now, paying out over seconds — it rewards your poke pattern, not the all-in.

 **SETUP C — Electrocute**

ALTERNATIVE — burst feel without the HoB commitment

Primary — Domination	Secondary — Precision	Shards	Build order
Electrocute Sudden Impact Grisly Mementos Treasure Hunter	Presence of Mind Coup de Grace	Adaptive Adaptive Health	Same lethality core as Setup A/B: Doran's →  Brutalizer →  Voltaic → Glutt. Greaves →  Axiom →  Serylda's

YOUR DATA Your existing Electrocute page (14 games). Procs off Q1 + packmates + one auto — fits your poke pattern. The current-patch data has it ~1.5–2pp behind HoB/DFT (51.8%), so it's the third option now, not the first.



SETUP D — DFT Bruiser

VS BULKY COMPS — 2+ divers/juggernauts on you, or no frontline of your own

Primary — Sorcery

Deathfire Touch
Manaflow Band
Transcendence
Scorch

Secondary — Precision

Legend: Haste
Cut Down

Shards

Adaptive
Adaptive
HP%

Build order

Doran's → Caulfield's → **Eclipse**
→ Glutt. Greaves → **Black**
Cleaver → **Death's Dance** →
 Endless Hunger or Maw
(vs AP) → GA

VERIFIED per-slot, DFT games only: Eclipse 1st 54.1% (58% at Gold, directional), Cleaver 2nd 55.4%, Death's Dance 62.7% as 4th, Endless Hunger 68.8% as 4th (all keystones), GA the closer. This is your build with two data-driven changes. **(1) Endless Hunger/Maw over Spirit Visage:** SV's +25% heal amp is mechanically real on your Q heal/DD/omnivamp but statistically invisible (~21 games league-wide); Maw covers the same MR need with 60 AD and data behind it. **(2) Eclipse earns its slot here, not on lethality pages:** its 2-hit proc (6% max-HP damage + shield) pays both ways in extended trades, but as a lethality first item it's -2pp vs Voltaic — buy it only in this build. Axiom Arc still slots 2nd over Cleaver when you're getting takedowns (55.0%). **MEASURED** The burst tax is $\sim\frac{1}{3}$ vs the same target (\$5) — this build wins rotations two and three, never rotation one. Cleaver note: 26.11 made the DFT burn magic-only, so the burn no longer stacks Carve — but your packmates and Q bleed stack it near-instantly anyway (wiki-verified), covering the ~88% of your damage that's physical.

Component cheat sheet — what to buy on each back **VERIFIED** (recipes: Riot Data Dragon 16.13.1)

Component	Builds into	Buy it when
The Brutalizer (1337g)	Voltaic (+2 Long Swords), Axiom Arc (+Caulfield's), Profane Hydra, Bastionbreaker — the core uses two	Default first back on Setups A/B/C
Caulfield's Warhammer (1050g)	Axiom Arc, Serylda's, Hubris, Eclipse, Death's Dance, Endless Hunger, Maw	Second back, or first back on Setup D
Serrated Dirk (1000g)	Hubris, Edge of Night, Youmuu's, Serpent's Fang, Umbral, Bastionbreaker — NOT Voltaic	Only when pivoting Hubris (\$4) or an EoN/utility slot
Last Whisper (1450g)	Serylda's Grudge	Third-item territory

Boots timing: every verified sequence, Emerald+ through Master+ (op.gg, lolalytics), slots completed boots as the **second full purchase:** first legendary → boots → second legendary. Basic Boots (300g) on an early back only if you have spare gold and the lane punishes slow feet (skillshot mids). Never sit on tier-1 boots to the mid game — "T1 boots only" games run 38.8% WR. **Immortal Path** is a free Feats-of-Strength upgrade (0g) — take it the moment it's offered. No site publishes purchase minute-stamps (onetricks.gg is bot-walled, leagueofgraphs blocks fetches), so treat "boots ~min 12-15" as approximate. Note lolalytics' most-common mid line opens **Hubris → Greaves → Voltaic**; op.gg and Master+ data open Voltaic, and Voltaic-first is what your winning games run — treat Hubris-first as the snowball variant, per \$4.

2b · The HoB route ("how do I go in") REASONING

HoB does nothing until you commit to auto range — it plays like a Diana or Kata all-in: poke is only there to set up the one committed sequence. **Condition** minutes 1-5 with normal Q1 poke so they respect it. **The read:** they're ~60% and just burned their dash/shield on a Q or a last-hit. **The sequence:** W (pre-cast) → E in → **AA-AA-AA** (the three HoB autos — skipping these wastes the keystone) → Q1 → Q2 → R if they flash. Post-6, R opens the same sequence from 900 range and a kill hands you the shielded recast home. Ten practice-tool reps, then normals until automatic.

3 · The Item Encyclopedia — what each item does for *her*, and what it opens up

Why every good Naafiri item says "on takedown" VERIFIED

One takedown event simultaneously fires: **R free recast + shield** · **Axiom Arc** CD refund · **Hubris** AD stack · **Gluttonous Greaves** omnivamp stack · **Death's Dance** cleanse/heal · **Endless Hunger** omnivamp burst. Her itemization isn't a stat checklist — it's stacking payouts onto the same event her ultimate already rewards. First kill in a fight → everything comes back online → second dive. That's the whole champion.

Core — in (almost) every game

Item	What it does for her	What it opens up
 Voltaic Cyclosword 3000g 53.6% WR / 87% of games	Ability hit triggers Energized: next auto = 9% of target's current HP phys + 15 lethality for 4s. Charges by moving — W/R movement speed and your roams charge it for free.	Kill pressure from even — no conditions, every engage. R → landing auto front-loads the 9% chunk before they react. First item in every setup for a reason.
 Axiom Arc 2750g 55.9% / 61%; standard 2nd	Takedown within 3s of damaging → refunds 10% (+0.25% per lethality) of R's total CD — ~20–25% at full build, stacking with R's own free recast.	The teamfight loop: R more than once per fight, and the \$7 tempo (mains measured ~20–30s effective late-game R CD after a double takedown — single source, but the formula backs it). This is why it's in every build, including bruiser.
 Serylda's Grudge 3000g 58.1% / 45%; standard 3rd	35% armor pen + your abilities slow targets under 50% HP by 30% .	Bruisers join your kill list (\$5 measured: ~90% of a bruiser at this spike), and low-HP targets can't walk away from Q2 or the dogs. Buy 3rd by default, earlier vs 2+ armor-stackers.
 Gluttonous Greaves 1000g 55.7% — best boots by +4pp	4% omnivamp, +0.6% per takedown (max 10 stacks) — and your Q bleed + packmates all feed it.	The sustain engine: poke that heals you, all-ins you exit healthier than you entered. Ionian/Mercs/Steelcaps all cost ~4pp of win rate — buy them only for a named threat, not comfort.

Utility lethality — pick by problem

Item	What it does for her	What it opens up
 Edge of Night 3000g 57.7% / 36%; 3rd-4th	Spell shield + 250 HP + 15 lethality.	Engaging through the one ability that kills you — hook, snare, charm, Malphite R. The direct fix for your teamfight deaths (§8). Mains' rule: buy vs "things that fk your ult or get you picked" (Lux, Blitz, Jhin, Teemo).
 Hubris 2800g 53.5% first / 58.7% second	+12 AD (+3 per kill) for 90s on takedown.	Snowball compounding — full rules in §4. Also legitimate 2nd-3rd once you're already ahead, not just first.
 Youmuu's Ghostblade 2800g 55.8%, n=895	20 MS out of combat; active: 20% MS + ghosting 6s.	Roam tempo — the §6 map game as an item. The alternative to Hubris when ahead: kills come from being places first, not from bigger numbers.
 Serpent's Fang 2500g 52.8%; 57.6% as 5th	Damaging a champion cuts shields they gain by 50% for 3s (and existing shields on first hit).	Kills through Shen/Karma/Lulu/Sterak's. Cheapest legendary in her pool — a fast, targeted answer, 2nd-5th as needed.
 Umbral Glaive 2800g 56.1%, n=132 — sleeper	60 AD/18 leth/15 AH; auto-sweeps and instantly kills wards near you.	The pick game: your §6 "hunt the warder" rule as an item. Small sample, real logic.
 Profane Hydra 2850g 55.2%, n≈1k	Tiamat + Brutalizer — AoE cleave + execute active.	Waveclear-into-roam tempo when you're shoving five waves a game. Fell out of favor post-midscope (Voltaic does the killing better); niche now.
 Bastionbreaker 3200g 56.9%, n=654	Brutalizer + Dirk (eats both forks). Abilities deal bonus true damage ; takedowns empower your next tower hit.	The anti-tank lethality slot when Serylda's isn't enough, plus real split-push teeth. Overperforms quietly in her data.

Traps & gone VERIFIED: **The Collector** — crit is wasted on her kit (packmates don't crit); 0.75% pick for a reason.

Opportunity — **removed from the game in 26.9**; ignore any build still listing it. **Sundered Sky** / **Sterak's** / **Stridebreaker** / **Hullbreaker** / **Ravenous** — essentially unplayed on her (n≤30 each league-wide); no data supports any of them.

Bruiser & defense — Setup D's shelf

Item	What it does for her	What it opens up
 Eclipse 2900g 54.1% first under DFT only	2 hits within 2s → 6% max-HP physical + a shield (160 +40% bAD, 6s CD). Q1→Q2 or Q→E procs it on demand.	Trading into melee range: the proc pays both ways — damage on them, shield on you. Still only correct as a DFT-page first item; on lethality pages it's -2pp vs Voltaic, whose current-HP proc front-loads harder.
 Black Cleaver 3000g 55.4% 2nd under DFT	6% armor shred per physical hit, 5 stacks — your packmates and Q bleed ticks stack it near-instantly (wiki-verified). 400 HP, +20 MS on hit.	The whole team's physical damage vs armor-stackers, plus the HP to stand in the fight you're shredding.
 Death's Dance 3300g 57.1%; best 4th (59.8–62.7%)	Incoming damage deferred over 3s; takedown cleanses the stored damage and heals .	Surviving the collapse that answers your dive — and the takedown-loop makes the cleanse near-guaranteed when you dive right. Vs sustained AD.
 Endless Hunger 3100g 64.4% overall; 68.8% as 4th	65 AD, 5% omnivamp, 20% tenacity ; takedown → 15% omnivamp for 8s.	The highest-WR bruiser-flavored item she has (selection-biased — winners buy it — but the tenacity + takedown-omnivamp fit is real). Fights that last two rotations.
 Maw of Malmortius 3100g 57.2% as 4th; trap 1st (45%)	Magic shield below 30% HP + 10% omnivamp until combat ends. 60 AD keeps your damage.	Diving fed AP through their burst window. Hexdrinker (1300g) is the early version in bad AP lanes.
 Guardian Angel 3200g 61.3%; best 5th (63.4%)	Revive at 50% base HP after 4s.	The closer: when you're the win condition, GA converts "confident flank" into "free flank". Standard ~min 32.
 Spirit Visage 2700g n≈21 league-wide — theorycraft	400 HP/50 MR; +25% to all your heals and shields (Q heal, DD, omnivamp, R-recast shield).	Your comfort pick. The multiplier is mechanically real and nobody has disproven it — but nobody's proven it either. If you keep it, know it's a belief, not a stat.

Anti-heal, one rule VERIFIED

Grievous Wounds is a flat **40%** on Summoner's Rift — no escalation. All her GW options run sub-52%, so buy for the named healer only: **Executioner's Calling** (800g) as the early stopgap → **Chempunk Chainsword** if the slot should be bruiser (450 HP; delay to 4th) or **Mortal Reminder** if it should be pen — but Mortal Reminder and Serylda's are both **Fatality** items: the shop only lets you own one.

Aggregate WRs on late/defensive items are survivorship-biased — buy for the named problem, not the number. Boot alternatives: Swifties 56.2% (n=742) are real anti-kite tech vs slow-stack comps; Merics/Steelcaps only under heavy specific threat — they trade away the omnivamp engine.

3b • Build by Their Comp, Not by Habit

REASONING Setups A–D (\$2) are complete answers to four different games — the skill is picking one at the loading screen instead of defaulting. Four questions, thirty seconds:

Question	The read	What it changes
1. Count their real tanks	SINGLE SOURCE Armor breakpoints (Dodge.gg 2026): under ~80 armor lethality wins; 80–120 even; over ~120 %pen wins. Squishies stay under 80 all game; tanks pass 120 by two items.	0–1 tanks: Setup B untouched — lethality at its best. 2 tanks: Serylda's climbs to 3rd (over EoN/Hubris). 3+: stop planning one-shots — go Setup D, where Cleaver covers the pen (Fatality rule: it's Cleaver <i>or</i> Serylda's, never both) and you win long fights instead. Either way the tank never becomes your target: SINGLE SOURCE "If you are hitting the frontline first, lethality gets worse. If you are threatening carries first, it gets better."
2. Read their damage — type <i>and</i> delivery	AD, AP or mixed; burst or DPS; autos or abilities. "Armor doesn't save you from AP burst. MR doesn't save you from fed crit autos."	Your defensive slot (4th–5th on A–C, ~3rd on D): AP burst → Maw. Sustained AP → Endless Hunger→Maw. AD autos → GA earlier. Dies-on-entry burst → the W-timing fix (§8) before any item — items don't fix walking in first. Mixed damage → HP-carrying items (Cleaver, EoN, Shojin) beat single resists.
3. Count YOUR frontline	VERIFIED The someone-must-soak rule: "If you are the only melee champion on your team, you need to be able to take hits." A Sejuani jungle or Leona support is your license for full glass.	Real tank on your team → Setups A/B; arrive second; flank "early, patient, lethal." Bruisers-only or all-squishy team → Setup D pulls double duty: second body <i>and</i> cleanup. What you never do: stay full-lethality <i>and</i> walk in first. And an assassin cannot item her way into being a frontline — the fix is a different setup, not a Sterak's taped onto Setup B.
4. Sum their healing & shields	SINGLE SOURCE Anti-heal pays when they heal 1,000+ HP per fight (auto-buy tier: Aatrox, Mundo, Vladimir, Soraka, Yuumi, Briar, Warwick). GW does not touch shields.	Named healer → §3's anti-heal rule, and one GW buyer per team — "two GW items is still 40%, not 80%." Shield stackers (Lulu/Karma/Janna, Shieldbow/Sterak's users) → Serpent's Fang: anti-shield and anti-heal are different problems with different items.

VERIFIED **Runes move with the comp too.** The finisher slot is a real choice: **Cut Down** currently reads "8% increased damage to champions *above 60% max health*" (re-verified this patch — not the old more-max-HP-than-you version), so it's best into HP-stackers who sit healthy all fight, and it front-loads your opening rotation on full targets. **Coup de Grace** (8% below 40%) is the resets rune — R executes and Q2's missing-HP detonation love it into squishy comps. And **Legend: Tenacity no longer exists** (removed 14.10): vs 3+ hard-CC chains the real answers are Mercs, Cleanse, or an Unflinching secondary.

Worked example — the hard case

REASONING Your team: bruiser top, no tank. Their team: three tanks, low damage. Walk the audit: **(1)** Three real tanks — lethality's targets don't exist; pen must be %-based, and your kill target is still their softest carry, probably the one mage. **(2)** Low damage — their threat is CC, not burst, so defense can wait a full slot. **(3)** No tank on your side — someone must soak, and that's **Setup D**, not full-glass Setup B walking in first. Cleaver doubles as your pen answer (Fatality-legal, unlike adding Serylda's to it). **(4)** Three tanks usually hide a Warmog's or Mundo — check whether a teammate has GW covered. **Answer: Setup D (Eclipse → Cleaver → DD), Cut Down over Coup, defense delayed one slot, flank after their engage lands on your bruiser.** Now invert it — their three assassins, your Ornn: Setup B untouched, EoN 3rd, Coup de Grace, and you never leave your carries' screen.

4 • Hubris vs Voltaic

REASONING from current tooltips (Data Dragon 16.13.1):

	 Voltaic Cyclosword — 3000g	 Hubris — 2800g
Stats	55 AD, 10 lethality, 10 haste	55 AD, 18 lethality , 10 haste
Passive	Energized burst on ability hit — unconditional , works every engage	+12 AD (+3/kill) for 90s on takedown — worthless until someone dies
Identity	Kills someone from even	Makes kills #2-5 faster; 90s window = fight-every-wave tempo

Rule: Voltaic is the default. Hubris only when takedowns are already guaranteed — **2-3 kills up before your first completed item** in a lane they can't win. Rushing Hubris even is circular: its passive needs kills to give you the stats to get kills.

The fork happens at first back, at the component level: buying **Brutalizer** commits toward Voltaic/Axiom; buying **Serrated Dirk** commits toward Hubris (Dirk + Caulfield's). Decide before you shop, not at 2600g.

Gold math: a clean solo kill $\approx$ 600g swing (300g bounty + $\sim$ 2 missed waves). Mid legendaries cost 2750–3300g, so **$\sim$ 3 uncontested solo kills $\approx$ one item of real advantage** — at 2–3 kills by first back you're past half an item, which is the Hubris window.

5 • Kill Thresholds by Spike — Measured

YOUR DATA Practice-tool tested 2026-07-05: full \$1b core combo per spike, squishy dummy 1700 HP / 70 armor, bruiser dummy 2300 HP / 120 armor. Your recorded totals are pre-mitigation; converted to actual HP damage with the wiki-verified armor formula (damage $\times$ 100/(100+armor); lethality = flat pen 1:1 since 14.1; percent pen applies before flat) **REASONING** . Lvl-8 row untested (model only).

Spike	vs Squishy	vs Bruiser	vs Tank	Verdict
Brutalizer + boots (lvl 8)	~68% model	—	—	Kill from ~65%; full-HP kills don't exist yet
Voltaic done (lvl 9-10)	~ 71% measured: 1934 raw → ~1210	~39% model	—	Kill squishies from ~70% — not from full; bruisers are trades only
+ Axiom Arc (lvl 11)	~ 117% measured: 2835 raw → ~1995	~60-70% model; your lvl-13 test ran ~25 pts above model, so trust the high end	—	The assassin license, confirmed with margin: a full-HP squishy dies to one R rotation.
+ Serylda's (lvl 13)	Overkill — a partly-missed Q still kills	~ 91% measured: 3252 raw → ~2085	~43% model	Bruisers die from ~ 90% — far better than modeled; tanks never — kite them with the Serylda's slow

The R tax — measured at 44%: the identical 2-item loadout dealt 2835 with R and 1599 without. With R down you do **barely over half your damage** — not the ~75-80% the old model claimed. With R down you are a poke champion, not an assassin; this rule is now a law.

The bruiser build's price, measured: Eclipse + Black Cleaver + Death's Dance (lvl 13, DFT) dealt 2346 raw into the same bruiser dummy — roughly **a third less burst** than the lethality line's 3252 against the identical target. The bruiser build never wins the one-rotation race; it wins by surviving rotations two and three (§2 Setup D).

Recalibrate per patch in 15 min with the same five tests. Tab check in game: their armor outgrowing your lethality = off your kill list.

6 • Laning & Roaming — The KP Fix

YOUR DATA 43% KP, low-KP losses at 27 min: lane won, map lost. This is the section that ranks you up.

Lane: your poke loop is right — Q1 at committed movement, packmates chip, hold E for the answer. Level 1-2 (Q→E) you win extended trades; most mids expect passive Naafiri. The one fix: poke that never becomes a kill, plates, or a roam is noise. Once they hit your \$5 threshold, **commit or leave** — usually leave: shove and spend the advantage elsewhere.

Matchups (lolalytics, current patch): hardest — **Riven, Talon, Qiyana**: melee ADs who win the early all-in. Play those like a Zed lane — E strictly defensive pre-6, concede the level-2/3 window, poke only after their gap-closer whiffs. Best — **LeBlanc, Ryze, Mel**: packmates eat their skillshots and your all-in outdamages theirs. General: artillery mages are your comfort zone; bruisers flexed mid — poke freely, no all-ins before Serylda's, shove and roam instead.

The rule: every wave crash into their tower = you owe the map a decision — **roam, invade with jungler, deep ward, or reset**. Never stand in lane waiting for the bounce. That wait is the 43%.

- **Green lights** **SINGLE SOURCE**: post-6 with R up (900-range point-and-click ganks), wave crashed, objective within ~45s, enemy mid dead/backed. Default route **bot → rotate Dragon**.
- **Red lights** **REASONING**: wave frozen against you, R down, bot already dove. A failed roam costs more than a skipped one.
- **Gold-elo cheat code** **SINGLE SOURCE**: mid-game supports walk the map alone — a face-checking support is 300g + a free objective for a 900-range targeted ult. Hunt the warder.

7 • Ahead But Can't Close

REASONING Kills are currency. While they're grey-screened, buy something, in order: **1)** Dragon/Herald/Baron · **2)** mid tower/plates · **3)** sweep + deep wards (the next pick comes from that darkness) · **4)** a crashed wave. Never just recall on a kill.

Mid-game loop when ahead (15-25 min): push side wave → ward flank → look mid for a pick with R up → objective off the pick → next side lane. Each lap is 60-90s and gains something. Your losses exit this loop — quiet side-farming while the enemy groups mid. If they group and no pick is available, **join your team immediately:** a 2-item Naafiri present beats a 3-item Naafiri arriving late.

5k+ lead at 20 min → group mid, take tower, end by ~28. She falls off as teams group **SINGLE SOURCE** — your best window is mid game, don't bank on late.

8 • Teamfights — Stop Dying on Entry

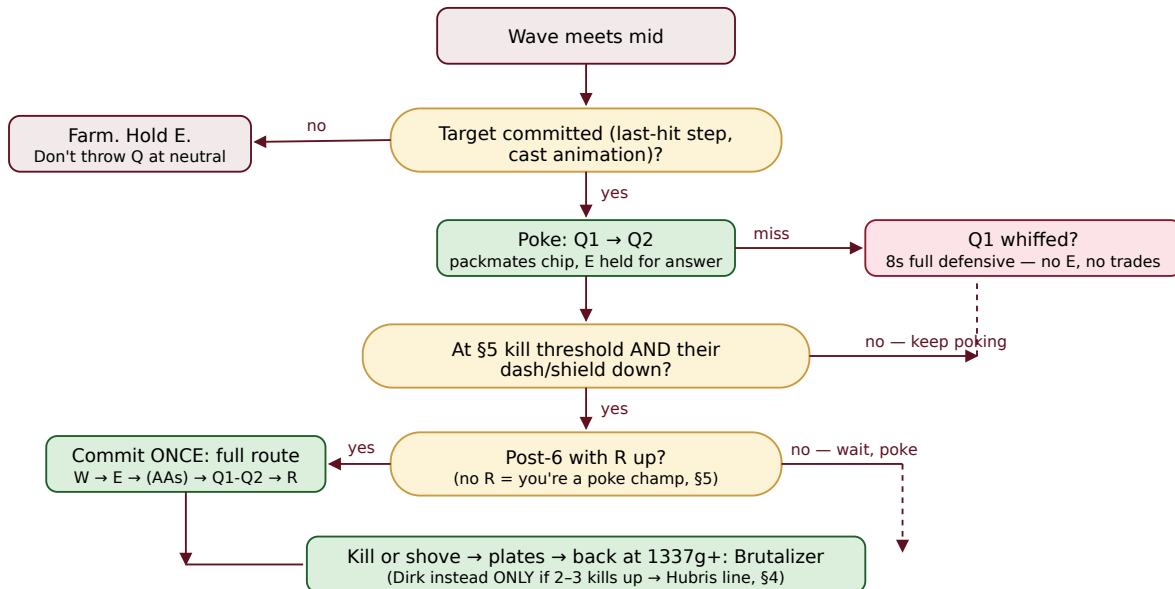
- **Never the opener.** Enter after their key CC (the hook, the Malphite R, the exhaust) has been spent on someone else — that's your window, same rule every good Kha'Zix follows.
- **Flank from fog/side bush** — R's 900 range means you never walk through the frontline. Late game: flank *near* your team, don't solo side-lane.
- **Pre-decide two targets:** squishiest reachable, plus the recast target. Never R a full-HP bruiser "because he was closest" (\$5 table).
- **The exit is the kill:** kill → shielded recast → target #2 or backward disengage. No certain kill = don't press the button.
- Still dying? Edge of Night next back (\$3). But entry timing, not items, is the real fix.

9 • Game Plan by Stage — Decision Flowcharts

Skeleton verified per stage (Mobalytics 26.13, single source); decision structure is coaching reasoning. Read each chart top to bottom every time its trigger fires.

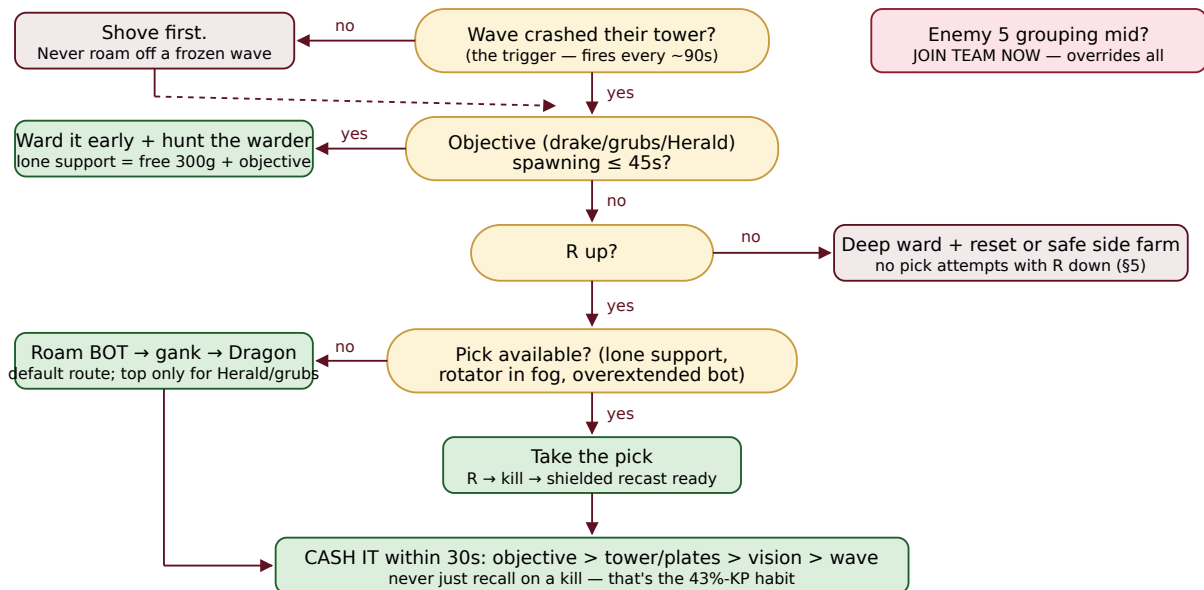
Early game (0-8): win the poke war, cash it in

Goals: hit 1337g for Brutalizer by first back (~minute 6-8) · keep CS $\geq$ 6.5/min (your winning games average 7.0) · force their escape with poke, then commit once · never trade while your Q is down.



Mid game (8-25): her prime — the phase your losses happen in

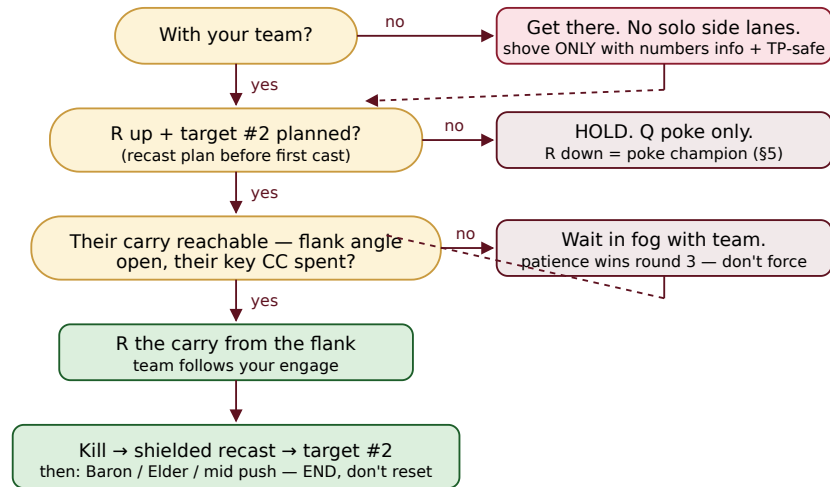
Goals: KP above 50% from here on · every R cooldown spent on a gank, pick, or objective setup · two items by ~16 min in a winning game · cash every kill within 30s (\$7 menu).



Late game (25+): one clean pick ends it

Goals: zero solo deaths (death timers are 40-60s — one mistake is Baron + the game) · stay within one screen of your team · every fight entry pre-planned: target #1, target #2, exit. She falls off as teams group

SINGLE SOURCE — you're not the win condition in a 40-min game, your *one pick* is.



Compiled 2026-07-04, rev 7.3 on 2026-07-06 (combos section §1b; §5 kill thresholds now MEASURED from your 5 practice-tool tests, armor math wiki-verified; keystone data re-verified on lolalytics 26.13 — HoB/DFT lead, Electrocute demoted; Setup D rebuilt to the research-optimal bruiser line; §3 rebuilt as the full item encyclopedia) · Patch 26.13, lolalytics Emerald+ aggregates (verified twice, 2026-07-05; will drift next patch) · Gold-lead heuristics and per-stage plan remain REASONING/single-source as labeled · Sources: LoL Wiki, Riot Data Dragon 16.13.1, patch notes 26.9–26.11, lolalytics, op.gg (incl. Master+), skill-capped, r/NaafiriMains (Mar–May 2025 archive; 2026 threads unreachable); player data via op.gg/u.gg; your practice-tool measurements 2026-07-05 · Images © Riot Games (Data Dragon CDN), non-commercial fan content.